



**College of Science & Technology
Computer Information Systems**

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

CAP 4620 301

FALL 2026

Credit Hours: 3

Instructor Information

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Additional Instructor Information

Office Location: Commons building, office G-142
Office Hours: M, W, F 2 pm - 4pm
Faculty Profile: <https://www.famu.edu/info/faculty-staff/profiles/cst/yohn-parrabautista.php>

Course Modality

In Person/Traditional

Course Description

**PROBLEM SOLVING AND REPRESENTATION, CONTROL STRATEGIES,
SEARCHING STRATEGIES, PREDICATE CALCULUS AND RULE-BASED
DEDUCTIONS, KNOWLEDGE-BASED SYSTEMS, ROBOTICS**

Textbooks and Instructional Materials

Title: Artificial Intelligence: A modern Approach
ISBN: 9780134671932
Authors: Stuart Russel and Peter Norving
Publisher: Pearson
Edition: 4th

Course Goals/Course Objectives

- **CLO 1** Students will explain and differentiate between supervised and unsupervised learning paradigms, including their underlying principles, appropriate use cases, and limitations.
- **CLO 2** Students will describe the mathematical foundations of core machine learning algorithms, including linear regression, logistic regression, decision trees, neural networks, clustering, and dimensionality reduction techniques.
- **CLO 3** Students will identify ethical concerns related to AI and machine learning applications, including bias, fairness, privacy, transparency, and societal impact.
- **CLO 4** Students will utilize Jupyter Notebooks and popular machine learning libraries (scikit-learn, pandas, numpy) to build, train, and deploy models efficiently.
- **CLO 5** Students will apply appropriate visualization techniques to explore data patterns, understand feature relationships, and communicate model insights effectively.
- **CLO 6** Students will evaluate machine learning model performance using appropriate metrics (accuracy, precision, recall, F1-score, ROC-AUC, MSE, etc.) and techniques (cross-validation, train-test splits).
- **CLO 7** Students will select and optimize machine learning models by comparing alternatives, tuning hyperparameters, and addressing overfitting or underfitting issues.
- **CLO 8** Students will interpret model outputs and predictions to extract meaningful insights and make data-driven recommendations for stakeholders.
- **CLO 9** Students will apply knowledge of Electronic Health Records (EHRs) to identify and evaluate key components that ensure data integrity, interoperability, and HIPAA compliance in AI-driven healthcare systems.
- **CLO 10** Students will differentiate between supervised and unsupervised learning paradigms by analyzing their underlying principles, use cases, and limitations within applied AI contexts.
- **CLO 11** Students will explain and apply the mathematical foundations of machine learning algorithms—such as regression models, decision trees, neural networks, clustering, and dimensionality reduction—to solve domain-specific problems.
- **CLO 12** Students will evaluate and address ethical and regulatory

challenges in AI and machine learning, focusing on bias, fairness, privacy, transparency, accountability, and societal impact.

- **CLO 13** Students will design and implement end-to-end machine learning workflows using Jupyter Notebooks and libraries such as scikit-learn, pandas, and numpy, demonstrating best practices in code modularity and reproducibility.
- **CLO 14** Students will apply data visualization and interpretability techniques to explore datasets, reveal feature relationships, and communicate insights effectively to technical and non-technical audiences.
- **CLO 15** Students will evaluate and optimize machine learning models using performance metrics (accuracy, recall, F1-score, ROC-AUC, MSE) and validation techniques (cross-validation, grid search) to enhance model reliability.
- **CLO 16** Students will integrate Agile methodology into AI project development by conducting iterative sprint planning, peer reviews, and continuous model improvement cycles. (Lightcast: Agile Methodology)
- **CLO 17** Students will design and automate AI pipelines using scripts, APIs, and cloud-based tools to improve model deployment, monitoring, and scalability. (Lightcast: Automation)
- **CLO 18** Students will apply software engineering principles—including version control (Git), modular design, and documentation—to develop maintainable, production-ready AI systems. (Lightcast: Software Engineering)
- **CLO 19** Students will troubleshoot and refine AI models by diagnosing performance issues, debugging code, and implementing solutions that improve efficiency and accuracy. (Lightcast: Troubleshooting)
- **CLO 20** Students will create strategic project plans outlining research questions, data sources, resource allocation, and deliverables for AI-driven applications, demonstrating effective technical and organizational planning. (Lightcast: Planning)

Student Learning Outcomes

- **ABET SLO-4** Recognize professional responsibilities and make informed and equitable judgments in computing practice based on legal and ethical principles.
- **ABET SLO-6-CS** Apply computer science theory and software development fundamentals to produce computing-based solutions.

Course Outline/Topics Covered

WeekTopicsReading AssignmentsLab Assignments / ActivitiesAssessments

Course Outline Topics

1	Introduction to Machine Learning and Jupyter Notebooks	• Overview of AI and Machine Learning • Introduction to Jupyter Notebooks • Basics of NumPy and Pandas	Setting up the Python environment	Pre-Course Assessment Quiz
2	Data Preprocessing and Visualization	• Data cleaning techniques • Handling missing and categorical data • Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA)	Data visualization with Matplotlib and Seaborn	—
3	Supervised Learning – Regression	• Linear Regression concepts • Polynomial Regression • Regularization (Ridge, Lasso)	Implementation using Scikit-Learn	—
4	Supervised Learning – Classification	• Logistic Regression • k-Nearest Neighbors (k-NN) • Support Vector Machines (SVM)	Evaluation metrics: Accuracy, Precision, Recall, F1-Score	Test 1: Hands-on Mini-Project
5	Decision Trees and Ensemble Methods	• Decision Trees • Random Forests • Gradient Boosting Machines (XGBoost)	Feature importance and selection	—
6	Model Evaluation and Hyperparameter Tuning	• Cross-validation techniques	• Grid Search and Random Search • Overfitting vs. Underfitting • Learning and validation curves	Lab Assessment 1: Submit Jupyter Notebook demonstrating model evaluation and tuning
7	Unsupervised Learning – Clustering	• Introduction to Unsupervised Learning	• K-Means • Hierarchical Clustering • DBSCAN	—
8	Dimensionality Reduction Techniques	• Principal Component Analysis (PCA) • t-SNE • Linear Discriminant Analysis (LDA)	• Apply dimensionality reduction • Visualize high-dimensional data	Test 2: Hands-on Mini-Project
9	Association Rule Learning and Anomaly Detection	• Association Rule Mining (Apriori Algorithm) • Market Basket Analysis	• Implement association rule mining • Perform anomaly detection using Isolation Forest	Lab Assessment 2: Submit Jupyter Notebook on model evaluation and tuning
10	Introduction to Neural Networks and Deep Learning	• Basics of Neural Networks • Activation & Loss Functions • Intro to TensorFlow and Keras	• Build and train a simple neural network • Experiment with architectures	—
11	Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs)	• CNN Architecture and Components • Convolution and Pooling • Computer Vision Applications	• Implement CNN for image classification • Use data augmentation	—

12	Recurrent Neural Networks (RNNs) and LSTMs	• RNN Concepts• LSTMs and GRUs• Sequence Data Applications	• Build LSTM for time-series forecasting• Text generation using RNNs	—
13	Natural Language Processing (NLP)	• Text Preprocessing• Sentiment Analysis• Word Embeddings (Word2Vec, GloVe)	• Implement text classification using embeddings• Experiment with NLP models	Lab Assessment 3: Submit NLP Jupyter Notebook with interpretations
14	Reinforcement Learning and Ethical AI	• Reinforcement Learning & Q-Learning• Ethics in AI: Bias, Fairness, Privacy	• Implement a simple RL agent• Group discussion on ethical AI	—
15	Final Project Presentations & Course Review	—	Students present final projects (proposal started after Week 8)	Final Project Presentation

Additional Information

Students will:

- **Develop Core Machine Learning Competency:** Students will gain comprehensive understanding of fundamental machine learning principles, including the mathematical and computational foundations underlying both supervised and unsupervised learning algorithms, enabling them to select and apply appropriate techniques for diverse problem domains.
- **Achieve Practical Implementation Proficiency:** Students will develop hands-on expertise in implementing machine learning solutions using industry-standard tools (Python, Jupyter Notebooks, scikit-learn, TensorFlow/PyTorch), including the complete pipeline from data preprocessing and feature engineering through model training, evaluation, and optimization.
- **Master Data-Driven Problem Solving:** Students will cultivate the ability to approach real-world challenges through a machine learning lens, including formulating problems appropriately, selecting suitable algorithms, interpreting model outputs, and translating technical findings into actionable insights for various stakeholders.
- **Integrate Ethical AI Practices:** Students will develop critical awareness of the ethical implications and societal responsibilities inherent in machine learning applications, including issues of bias, fairness, transparency, and accountability, preparing them to deploy AI technologies responsibly in professional contexts.
- **Build Professional Communication Skills:** Students will develop the ability to effectively communicate complex machine learning concepts, methodologies, and results to both technical and non-technical audiences through written reports, visualizations, and presentations, bridging the gap between data science and business applications.

Grading Scale

Grading Scale	
Grade	Percentage
A	90% - 100%
B	80% - 89%
C	70% - 79%
D	60% - 69%
F	59% and Below

Course Assessment/Evaluation Methods (Examinations, Quizzes, Case Studies, Papers, Etc.)

Description Course Weights Evaluation

Lab Assignments	40%
Lab Assessments	20%
Tests	20%
Participation	10%
Quizzes	10%
Total Possible Points	100%

University Grading Policies and Procedures

The University supports its grading system which is based upon the integrity of a grade earned in a course. The FAMU full BOT 4.101 grading policy and withdrawal can be [viewed here](http://catalog.famu.edu/content.php?catoid=8&navoid=571#grading-policy). (<http://catalog.famu.edu/content.php?catoid=8&navoid=571#grading-policy>)

The University grievance policy is outlined in regulation 4.100. ([https://www.famu.edu/about-famu/leadership/division-of-legal-affairs/office-of-the-general-counsel/university_regulations/pdf/Regulation 4.100 Academic Grievances.pdf](https://www.famu.edu/about-famu/leadership/division-of-legal-affairs/office-of-the-general-counsel/university_regulations/pdf/Regulation%204.100%20Academic%20Grievances.pdf))

Class Attendance

Students are expected to make the most of the educational opportunities available by regularly attending classes and laboratory periods. The university reserves the right to address individual cases of non-attendance. A student will be permitted one unexcused absence per credit hour of the course he or she is attending. A

student exceeding the number of unexcused absences may be assigned the grade of “F.” Class attendance regulations apply to all students. Students are responsible for all assignments, quizzes, and examinations at the time they are due and may not use their absence from class as a plea for extensions of time to complete assignments or for permission to take make-up examinations or quizzes. Absence from class for cause: (a) participation in recognized university activities, (b) personal illness, or (c) an emergency beyond the student control must be properly documented.

Academic units may also have attendance policies specific to their majors. Please refer to your college/school specific attendance policy for your respective major.

Tips for Success

- **Stay Consistent with Weekly Work**
 - Homework and discussions are due every Sunday by 11:59 p.m., with no late submissions accepted. Plan ahead and don't wait until the last minute to complete assignments
- **Engage Fully in Class Discussions**
 - Participation is a significant part of your grade (20% for discussions + 10% for participation). Contributing thoughtful insights, responding to peers, and applying course readings will help boost your performance.
- **Prepare for Exams with Lecture and Reading Materials**
 - Exams are based on both chapter content and lectures. Keeping up with readings, taking notes, and reviewing videos and codes of ethics in each module will strengthen exam performance
- **Communicate and Seek Help Early**
 - If challenges arise, reach out promptly. The syllabus emphasizes student assistance and encourages contacting the instructor or university resources (such as CeDAR) to ensure success

Academic Learning Compact

Academic Learning Compacts include statements of the core student learning outcomes in the areas of content/ discipline knowledge and skills, communication skills, and critical thinking skills that program graduates will have adequately demonstrated prior to being awarded the baccalaureate degree. ALCs answer three basic questions:

1. What will students learn by the end of their academic programs?
2. Have they learned what they have been taught by their professors?
3. How do we measure these quantities?

Academic Learning Compacts for FAMU's undergraduate programs can be found at <https://www.famu.edu/administration/strategic-planning-analysis-and-institutional-effectiveness/university-assessment/academic-learning/current-alcs.php>.

College/School Policies and Standards

Make Up Policy

University policies for class attendance will be strictly adhered to. An excuse for an absence can only be obtained from the office of your Dean. Also, official excuses should be turned in within a week of the last day of absence. Missed tests will automatically receive a grade of zero if official excuses are not provided within a week of the absence. Without submitting the excuse to the instructor, you should NOT contact the instructor directly or indirectly on any matter related to that absence, missed assignments, or retest.

Procedure for Resolving Faculty-Student Conflict

1. Student first attempts to resolve issue with instructor.
2. Student submits written notification of problem to chairperson.
3. Chair forwards student letter to instructor.
4. Instructor responds in writing to chairperson.
5. Chairperson meets with instructor and/or student if necessary.
6. Chairperson forwards response/recommendation to Dean's office.
7. Dean decides what further course of action is available to the student.

CIS Academic Appeal Process (AAP)

The Department of Computer and Information Sciences (CIS) intends to provide a fair and consistent process to allow a student the opportunity to appeal an issue pertaining to academic matters. The student is encouraged to confer with the instructor to resolve the issue before submitting an AAP form.

When a student has an academic decision to be reviewed by the Department of Computer and Information Sciences (concerning any issue directly related to course performance), the student should take the following steps:

1. Within three (3) working days after a situation or event in question, the student should attempt to resolve the issue with the instructor of the course to which it is related.
2. If the issue remains unresolved, the CIS AAP Form should be submitted by the student to the CIS Main Office. The AAP Form should include a

- summary and other information and documentation describing the situation. The student should submit the CIS AAP Form within five (5) working days after the meeting with the instructor.
3. The CIS Department Chair will review the appeal and offer a Recommendation for the Student or Faculty within ten (10) business days.
 4. The faculty member revisits the student's request with the Chairperson's Recommendation to form their conclusion.
 5. If the student is not satisfied with the faculty member's conclusion, he or she may file an Academic Grievance with the College of Science and Technology (CST).

Intent to File an Academic Grievance (College of Science and Technology)

Students must submit Intent to Grieve Forms online within two weeks of grades being made available for students to view in accordance with the University Registrar's calendar. Students cannot submit an Academic Grade Grievance without previously submitting an Intent to Grieve Form unless they receive an exception from the Associate Dean.

Students must submit the Academic Grade Grievance to the College of Science and Technology Dean's Office no later than three weeks after the student receives the outcome of the CIS Department's Academic Appeal Process (AAP).

Academic Grievance will be reviewed if an Intent to Grieve Form is filed by the stated deadline or an exception is provided by the Associate Dean, allowing the student to submit a grievance without filing an "Intent to Grieve form."

All properly submitted Grievances will be placed on the Grievance Committee calendar in the College of Science and Technology.

Course and Student Expectations

Course Expectations

- Students are expected to have a working computer to complete assignments and not use their smartphone.
- Complete all assigned readings, videos, and activities before class discussions.
- Submit homework, discussions, and projects on time (no late work accepted).
- Prepare for exams by reviewing lectures, textbook chapters, and

supplemental materials.

- Actively engage in discussions, mini-presentations, and group activities to enhance learning.
- Follow academic integrity guidelines and properly cite any use of AI or other tools in assignments.

Student Expectations

- Attend virtual class regularly and on time; absences beyond three sessions may impact your grade.
- Bring necessary materials (charged laptop, notebook, textbook access) to each class.
- Participate respectfully and thoughtfully in discussions, demonstrating professionalism.
- Check Canvas and your FAMU email daily for announcements, grades, and instructor feedback.
- Take initiative in seeking help from the instructor or university resources when needed.
- Conduct yourself according to FAMU's dress and conduct standards, and keep cell phones silent during class.

Class Recordings

A student may record a class lecture for three specified purposes as outlined in [House Bill 233/section 1004.097](http://www.leg.state.fl.us/STATUTES/index.cfm?App_mode=Display_Statute&URL=1000-1099/1004/Sections/1004.097.html) (http://www.leg.state.fl.us/STATUTES/index.cfm?App_mode=Display_Statute&URL=1000-1099/1004/Sections/1004.097.html),

Florida Statutes:

1. For the student's own personal educational use;
2. In connection with a complaint to the University where the recording is made; or
3. As evidence in, or in preparation for, a criminal or civil proceeding.

Students may audio or video record a class lecture for a class in which the student is enrolled. A class lecture is defined as an [educational presentation

delivered by faculty or guest lecturer] OR [faculty-delivered educational presentation], as part of a Florida A&M University course, intended to inform or teach enrolled students about a particular subject. A class lecture does not include lab sessions, student presentations, clinical presentations such as patient history, academic exercises involving student participation, assessments (quizzes, tests, exams), field trips, private conversations between students in the class or between a student and the faculty or lecturer during a class session. Students may record at any time during a class lecture, so long as the recording is made for one of the above listed specific purposes.

A recording of a class lecture may not be published without the [written] consent of the lecturer. Publish means share, transmit, circulate, distribute, or provide access to a recording, regardless of format or medium, to another person (or persons), including but not limited to another student within the same class section. Additionally, a recording, or transcript of the recording, is considered to be published if it is posted on or uploaded to, in whole or in part, any media platform, including but not limited to social media, magazine, newspaper or leaflet.

Students may record a class lecture under the specified purposes listed above without informing the lecturer or receiving consent from the lecturer.

Academic and Student Support Services (Help Outside of Class)

- Academic Advising - <https://www.famu.edu/students/student-resources/academic-support/academic-advising/index.php>
- Continuing Education - <https://www.famu.edu/academics/continuing-education-and-professional-development/index.php>
- Counseling and Psychological Services - <https://www.famu.edu/students/student-resources/health-and-wellbeing/counseling-services/individual-counseling.php>
- Course Catalog - <http://catalog.famu.edu/>
- Course Syllabi Listing - <https://syllabi.famu.edu/>
- Excess Credit Hours - <https://www.famu.edu/academics/registrar-office/registration/excess-credit-hours.php>
- Financial Aid - <https://www.famu.edu/students/office-of-financial-aid/>
- Graduate Programs - <https://graduateschool.famu.edu/about-graduate-academics.php>
- Graduate Studies - <https://graduateschool.famu.edu/index.php>
- Honors Program - <https://www.famu.edu/academics/undergraduate-academics/honors-program/index.php>
- Libraries - <https://library.famu.edu/>
- List of Majors - <https://www.famu.edu/academics/undergraduate-academics/index.php>

- Registrar's Office - <https://www.famu.edu/academics/registrars-office/index.php>
- Registration Requirements & Procedures - <https://www.famu.edu/academics/registrars-office/registration/registration-requirements-and-procedures.php>
- Schedule of Classes - https://irattlercs-ext.famu.edu/psp/famremote/EMPLOYEE/SA/c/FAM_REMOTE_SELECTS.CLASS_SEARCH.GBL?tab=FAM_REMOTE
- Student Affairs - <https://www.famu.edu/administration/division-of-student-affairs/index.php>
- Study Abroad - <http://www.famu.edu/students/international-education-and-development/index.php>
- Technical Support (ITS) - <https://www.famu.edu/administration/campus-services/information-technology-services/>
- Transfer Students - <https://www.famu.edu/academics/transfer-student-services/index.php>
- Undergraduate Programs - <https://www.famu.edu/academics/undergraduate-academics/>
- Undergraduate Student Success Center - <https://www.famu.edu/academics/undergraduate-academics/undergraduate-student-success-center/index.php>
- Writing Across the Curriculum - <https://www.famu.edu/administration/sacs/quality-enhancement-plan/wac-resources.php>
- Writing Resource Center - <https://www.famu.edu/students/student-resources/writing-resource-center/index.php>
- For additional resources view the [FAMU Student Life Page](https://www.famu.edu/students/index.php). (<https://www.famu.edu/students/index.php>)

University Mission, Vision, and Values

Mission

Florida Agricultural and Mechanical University (FAMU) is an 1890 land grant, doctoral/research institution devoted to student success at the undergraduate, graduate, doctoral and professional levels. FAMU enhances the lives of its constituents and empowers communities through innovative teaching, research, scholarship, partnerships, and public service. The University continues its rich legacy and historic mission of educating African Americans and embraces all dimensions of diversity.

Vision

Florida Agricultural and Mechanical University (FAMU) will be recognized as a leading national public university that is internationally renowned for its competitive graduates, transformative research, and innovation.

Values

Florida Agricultural and Mechanical University is committed to the values of accountability, inclusion, innovation, and integrity. The University also values and endorses the Board of Governors' Statement of Free Expression and expects open-minded and tolerant civil discourse to take place throughout the campus community. These values represent the tenets that guide our actions, enable us to sustain our historical mission, and realize our strategic plan.

Schools/College Mission, Vision, and Values

The College of Science and Technology is dedicated to preparing our students to be scholars and leaders by providing an open atmosphere where students encounter patient and fair individuals who are caring, passionate, and vested in their success. Our faculty will use relevant techniques and pedagogy to strengthen student capability in solving problems independently, thereby producing responsible citizens focused on contributing to science and technology to enhance society.

Academic Honor Policy Statement

Florida A&M University is committed to academic honesty and its core values, which include scholarship, excellence, accountability, integrity, fairness, respect, and ethics. These core values are integrated into this academic honesty policy. The academic honesty policy shall be adhered to by all Florida A&M University students and applies to all academic work, both inside and outside of class. Being unaware of the Academic Honesty Policy is not a defense for violations of academic honesty. Additional detail on FAMU Academic Dishonesty Violations are provided in University Regulation 2.012 (8)(a). If you have any questions, please see your Academic Advisor. ([https://www.famu.edu/administration/division-of-student-affairs/office-of-student-conduct-and-conflict-resolution/documents/Regulation 2.012_Student Code of Conduct 12082021.pdf](https://www.famu.edu/administration/division-of-student-affairs/office-of-student-conduct-and-conflict-resolution/documents/Regulation%202.012_Student%20Code%20of%20Conduct%2012082021.pdf))

Additionally, the Student Code of Conduct sets forth the rules, regulations, and expected behavior of students enrolled. Violations of any rules, regulations or behavioral expectations may result in a charge of violating the Student Code of Conduct. It is the student's responsibility to read the Student Code in addition to the [Academic Honor Policy](#). Conduct and comply with these expectations.

(<https://www.famu.edu/about-famu/leadership/board-of-trustees/pdf-policies/Academic%20Honesty%20Policy%207.27.17.pdf>)

Anti-Hazing

Florida Agricultural and Mechanical University (“University”) strictly prohibits any student(s), group(s) of students, or student organization(s) affiliated with the University from engaging in any form(s) of hazing activities. Moreover, the University has zero tolerance for violation of any provisions of the Anti-hazing Regulation 2.028. ([https://www.famu.edu/students/student-resources/hazing-prevention/pdf/2_028 AntiHazing Approved 071513.pdf](https://www.famu.edu/students/student-resources/hazing-prevention/pdf/2_028%20AntiHazing%20Approved%20071513.pdf)) “Zero tolerance” means that given the factual circumstances of the alleged violation, the charged student may be removed from University Housing and receive a penalty up to suspension or expulsion from the University. Educate yourself about hazing and take the pledge to be an advocate for anti-hazing on campus. If you see something, SAY something! To report an emergency or a dangerous situation that is underway, CALL 911 for immediate police response.

FAMU Department of Campus Safety & Security
2400 Wahnish Way POM Bldg. A, Suite 128
Tallahassee, Florida 32307
P: (850) 599-3256
F: (850) 561-2615
E: fampol@famu.edu (<mailto:fampol@famu.edu>)

Accommodations for Students with Disabilities

The Center for Disability Access & Resources (CeDAR) has an online platform called AIM, allowing students with disabilities to register for services, request accommodations, schedule tests, and receive correspondence electronically. All requests must be made in the AIM portal. Students can access the AIM portal via their iRattler dashboard tiles. New students interested in receiving services will need to complete an application and upload a copy of documentation from a qualified professional through the AIM portal. Questions can be answered by contacting cedar@famu.edu (<mailto:cedar@famu.edu>) or calling 850-599-3180. You can also visit us at the CASS building, Suite 102, 1735 Wahnish Way, Tallahassee, FL 32307.

Online/Distance Education Statement

The mission of FAMU Online is to increase access to high-quality collegiate courses by utilizing educational technologies and emerging content delivery methods that allow for the development of professional proficiencies, personal growth, and the fostering of interpersonal effectiveness. Florida A&M University (FAMU) offers several Online courses and programs, both on the undergraduate and graduate degree levels. FAMU's online students are governed by the same policies and procedures that are in place to protect the privacy of all students. The University's written policies and procedures that apply are: Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA), Access to Student Records, Information Security Policy, and University Code of Conduct. Most of our classes use a Learning Management System (LMS) to provide ready access to course materials, and other student-centric resources. Students are encouraged to check CANVAS frequently for class updates and announcements. Canvas easily connects instructors with students, and is used to monitor grades, assignments, and share course documents.

Policy Statement on Non-Discrimination

It is the policy of Florida Agricultural and Mechanical University to assure that each member of the University community be permitted to work or attend classes in an environment free from any form of discrimination including race, religion, color, age, disability, sex, marital status, national origin, veteran status and sexual harassment as prohibited by state and federal statutes. This shall include applicants for admission to the University and employment.

Important University Dates

[Official FAMU Academic Calendars](#)

Mental Health

Being successful in this course is dependent on many factors, including your personal well-being. As a student you may experience a range of stressors that can cause barriers to learning and impact your overall health. This may include anxiety, high levels of stress, depression, trauma, grief, and strained relationships, to name a few. You are a priority and there are a numerous people

at FAMU waiting to assist you in your academic journey, including myself. Please reach out to me if you are experiencing any type of difficulty that may impact your success in this course. In addition, the Office of Counseling Services (OCS) offers FREE, confidential, in-person and virtual counseling for enrolled students. They also partner with BetterMynd, an online 24/7 therapy platform. This is also FREE to enrolled students. To learn more about on Counseling Services or BetterMynd, [visit the OCS website](#) or call (850) 599-3145. If you are experiencing a crisis and need to speak with a licensed mental health professional after hours, during holiday breaks, or even at 3 in the morning, you can call OCS' crisis line at (844) 287-6963.

"FAMU Alert" Emergency Notification System

Students, please scan the QR code to download the Everbridge app, sign up, and learn more about FAMU's Emergency Notification System "FAMU ALERT" or visit <https://www.famu.edu/alerts>. If you have any questions, please email famualert@famu.edu.



<https://member.everbridge.net/1864226259861522/ov>

Disclaimer

This syllabus is intended to provide student guidance on the type of content and activities that will be covered in this course throughout the semester. It will be followed to the greatest extent possible. However, modifications may be made to supplement and/or enhance student learning.